there are, in all, 301.46 million records of rights in the country; there are about two-and-a-half records of rights for each operational holding.

There are three major deficiencies in DILRMP. First, it computerizes the record of rights as it exists in the states. There is no national template. These records are also only available in the local language. As a result, there is no national registry. Second, the records essentially state the status of tenancy/ownership of a person over the surveyed plot of land. It is also a static record; assignment of different rights in the land, such as leasing, mortgage, etc., are either not recorded or updated. Thus, it is not a comprehensive record of ownership and other attributes of ownership over land. It is not a live record of 'ownership rights' in the land. Third, the record is maintained basically for agricultural land. Urban areas or abadi areas usually get clubbed into one or a few survey numbers. The responsibility of maintaining a record of buildings is entrusted to urban bodies. In practice, there is no system of recognizing land in non-agricultural areas (residential, industrial and infrastructure). The record thus accounts for only a part of the land parcels in the country.

It is extremely important for India to evolve an integrated system of land survey and record, covering both rural and urban areas. There should be a national template that can provide additional information. We need to move beyond recording ownership and other rights only from an agricultural standpoint. A National System of Land Records is necessary. We must embark on a ten-year mission to survey all land—agricultural, residential, businesses, housing, infrastructure—recording the type of activity the land is subject to, ownership and other attributes. This national record should be managed by a depository institution. The register should be dynamic, with every change relating to ownership or rights in land being recorded as part of the transaction itself. It should also be available in the public domain.